

Romantic Interactive Website — Step-by-Step Build Playbook

Reference source: [Video-33235.mp4](#) (39s, portrait capture of a phone screen recording of a Canva-site style interactive romantic web experience — domain shown on-screen: [templatediaryy.my.canva.site](#))

How to use this document: Build the site in the exact order below. Each Step contains a **Build Instructions** block (no code — describes what to construct, how it behaves, and why) and a  **Checkpoint** block. Do not move to the next Step until every item in the Checkpoint passes. This turns the build into a self-verifying pipeline so a developer (or QA reviewer) can confirm progress objectively at every stage instead of discovering problems at the end.

Where the reference video does not show something with 100% clarity (e.g., exact hex codes, exact millisecond timings, exact sound effects), this is explicitly marked "**Estimated Implementation**" — build it as reasonably close as possible to what is described, but do not treat the number as ground truth pulled from the video.

0. High-Level Summary of What You're Building

A **single-page, scroll-free, click-through interactive romantic reveal website** designed to be sent as a personal gift/link (a "digital love letter" experience). It is built card-by-card / scene-by-scene rather than as a long scrolling page — each interaction reveals the next scene, similar to a slideshow with an unlock gate at the front door.

Full scene order confirmed from the reference video:

1. Lock Screen — "Enter a passcode" keypad
2. Wrong Passcode error state (shake/prompt to retry)
3. Successful unlock transition
4. "Surprise Awaiting <3" teaser screen
5. "Click on items to open" — Scene A (gift box + heart-shaped collage of mini icons)
6. Love letter scene (handwritten-style paragraph over floral background)
7. "Everything I Love About You" — heart jar / reasons list scene
8. "Click on items to open" — Scene B (second heart collage, repeated pattern with a couple illustration cameo)
9. Embedded music/video scene — YouTube-style lyric video ("Until I Found You" — Stephen Sanchez ft. Em Beihold)
10. Now-playing lyric card with mini audio player controls (loop icon, prev/play/next, timestamp scrubber)
11. Photo memory grid scene — "Here's a little reminder of how pretty you are <3" (4-photo strip with heart icon header)
12. "Click on items to open" — Scene C (repeats gift/heart collage, leads to final reveal)

13. Final certificate scene — "BEST GIRLFRIEND AWARD" personalized card with recipient name and message
14. (Video ends here; site likely continues/loops or ends on this card — **Estimated Implementation** for anything beyond this point)

Design language: Cottagecore / scrapbook / soft pastel romantic aesthetic. Hand-drawn doodle icons, plaid/gingham backgrounds, serif script headline fonts mixed with a soft rounded sans-serif body font, pastel pink + sage green + cream color palette, paper/sticker-collage motifs (washi-tape style borders, "CUTE" signpost sticker, floating hearts/stars/butterflies).

STEP 0 — Project Setup & Foundations

Build Instructions

- Set up a single-page project (static site or single-page app). Because the whole experience is scene-based, not URL-routed, treat each "scene" as a full-viewport container that shows/hides rather than a separate page.
- Define a global "scene manager" concept: only one scene is visible at a time; all others are mounted but hidden (or lazily rendered) so transitions can crossfade instead of hard-cutting.
- Set the base canvas to a fixed content stage that is centered on screen with letterboxing on very wide screens (the reference video shows the whole experience living inside a bordered "frame," like a card floating on a neutral backdrop — **Estimated Implementation:** this may just be an artifact of the phone recording rather than an intentional in-site frame; assume a normal full-bleed responsive layout unless told otherwise).
- Establish font loading, color tokens, spacing tokens, and icon/doodle asset folders before building any scene (see Design System step below, Step 1).
- Decide on tech approach for "clickable items" interactions (Step 5 onward): each item should be an independently tappable hotspot, not one giant image.

✅ Checkpoint — Step 0

- ☐ Project scaffold runs locally / previews in browser with a blank canvas.
 - ☐ A scene-switching mechanism exists and can toggle between at least 2 dummy placeholder scenes.
 - ☐ Base responsive canvas is centered and scales down gracefully at mobile widths (test at 1440px, 768px, 390px).
 - ☐ Folder structure for assets (fonts, icons, images, audio) exists (see Step 16 for full structure).
 - ☐ No console errors on load.
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STEP 1 — Design System First (Colors, Type, Spacing, Icons)

Build the design system before any real scene, so every subsequent screen pulls from the same tokens instead of one-off styling.

Build Instructions

Color palette (sampled from video, treat exact hex as Estimated Implementation):

Token	Approx Color	Where used
bg-cream	Warm off-white ( #FBF7F0)-ish)	Card backgrounds, letter scenes
bg-blush	Soft pink ( #F7D9DD)-ish)	Passcode panel, surprise screens
bg-sage	Muted sage/olive green ( #DCE3C4)-ish)	Passcode screen left panel (gingham)
accent-red	Warm red/maroon ( #B23A3A)-ish)	Headline script text, "Wrong Passcode," CTA buttons
accent-pink	Bright bubblegum pink ( #F2A6C4)-ish)	Gift box ribbon, hearts
text-dark	Deep brown/black ( #3A2E2E)-ish)	Body copy, handwritten letter text
text-muted	Soft rose-grey	Secondary labels

- Typography: use **one script/serif display font** for romantic headlines ("Enter a passcode," "Everything I Love About You," "BEST GIRLFRIEND AWARD") and **one handwriting-style font** for the love-letter body text, plus a **rounded sans-serif** for UI labels/buttons. (Estimated Implementation for exact font families — visually consistent with Google Fonts like "Playfair Display"/"Alex Brush" for script and "Quicksand"/"Poppins" for UI, and a handwriting font like "Caveat" or "Homemade Apple" for the letter.)
- Spacing scale: define small/medium/large paddings (e.g., 8/16/24/32/48px) — every scene in the video uses generous whitespace and centered compositions.
- Icon/doodle style: flat, hand-drawn outline illustrations (the chick/bird mascot character, hearts, stars, butterflies, a signpost reading "CUTE"). Source or commission a consistent doodle icon set — mixing icon styles will break the aesthetic.
- Border radius: soft/large rounding on all buttons and cards (pill-shaped buttons, rounded card corners).
- Background pattern: gingham/plaid check pattern used behind the passcode and "click to open" scenes; solid pastel/paper-texture background used behind letter and gallery scenes.

✓ Checkpoint — Step 1

- ☐ A documented color token file/style guide exists with all colors above named and reusable.
 - ☐ All three font roles (script headline, handwriting body, UI sans-serif) are loading correctly and render in a sample page.
 - ☐ Spacing scale is defined as reusable tokens (not hardcoded pixel values scattered through code).
 - ☐ At least the mascot chick character and 5 doodle icons (heart, star, butterfly, cassette tape, camera) are sourced/created in a consistent style.
 - ☐ Gingham/plaid background pattern asset is created and tileable without visible seams.
 - ☐ Buttons/cards preview with correct rounded corners and pastel shadows.
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STEP 2 — Build Scene 1: Passcode Lock Screen (First Screen Visitor Sees)

This is the very first scene the user lands on. No loading splash was visible in the reference video before this screen — the site opens directly on the passcode gate. (**Estimated Implementation:** a brief branded loading flash may exist before this but was not visibly captured; if you add one, keep it under 1 second and non-blocking.)

Build Instructions

- **Layout:** Split screen, two vertical halves.
 - Left half: sage-green gingham/plaid background with pink hearts and stars scattered as decoration, and a centered oval-framed illustration of the mascot chick holding a small flower bouquet, itself ringed by a heart-pattern border.
 - Right half: solid blush-pink background containing the interactive passcode UI.
- **Right-half content, top to bottom, centered:**
 1. Label text: "Enter a passcode" (rounded sans-serif, dark maroon/brown color, medium weight).
 2. A row of **4 empty square input boxes** (rounded corners, white fill, thin border) representing the 4 digits of the code. Boxes are empty/blank at rest.
 3. Below that, a **numeric keypad** arranged in the standard phone-dial layout: 1-2-3 / 4-5-6 / 7-8-9 / *-0-#. Each key is a white circular button with a dark maroon numeral, sitting on the pink background.
- **Input behavior:**
 - Tapping a digit key fills the next empty box left-to-right with a small filled marker/icon (in the video, the filled state shows a small flower/asterisk-style glyph inside the box rather than the literal digit — use a decorative "filled" glyph, not the plaintext digit, for a bit of light security/privacy plus thematic consistency).
 - Boxes fill one at a time as each key is tapped; there is no visible backspace key shown, but you should still implement one for usability (**Estimated**

Implementation — add a working backspace/clear affordance even though not explicitly seen).

- Once all 4 boxes are filled, the code is auto-submitted (no explicit "Enter" button was shown).
- **Two outcomes after the 4th digit:**
 - Wrong code → go to Step 3 (Wrong Passcode state).
 - Correct code → go to Step 4 (Unlock transition).
- Keep the browser-chrome / URL bar shown in the recording (templatediaryy.my.canva.site) in mind only as evidence of the platform used to prototype this — do not build actual browser chrome into your site.

✓ Checkpoint — Step 2

- ☐ Split-screen layout renders correctly with correct proportions on desktop and mobile (stack vertically on narrow mobile if needed — see Step 17).
- ☐ Mascot illustration + oval frame + heart border renders on the left panel, decorative stars/hearts scattered convincingly (not overlapping the illustration or text).
- ☐ "Enter a passcode" label displays correctly styled.
- ☐ 4 input boxes render empty by default, all same size, evenly spaced.
- ☐ Keypad renders 12 keys in correct telephone-style order (1-9, *, 0, #) with consistent circular styling.
- ☐ Tapping a key visually fills the next empty box with a marker glyph (not the raw digit).
- ☐ After 4 digits entered, system automatically evaluates the code (no manual submit needed).
- ☐ A working (even if visually hidden) backspace/reset exists so a mis-tap doesn't lock the user out of correcting themselves.
- ☐ Correct-code path and wrong-code path are both wired to route to two different next scenes.

STEP 3 — Build Scene 1b: Wrong Passcode State

Build Instructions

- On incorrect code entry, transition the right-hand passcode panel content out and swap the **entire visible content area** to a full-bleed light pink/lavender background covered in a soft sparkle/glitter texture (small white star and sparkle particles scattered across the background — decorative, non-interactive).
- Center-stage: the mascot chick character reacts with a surprised/upset expression (eyes wide, holding a small item, mouth in a flat "oops" line).
- Above the mascot: bold, arched/curved headline text reading "**WRONG PASSCODE!**" in the deep red/maroon accent color, hand-lettered marker style, laid out on a slight upward arc.

- Note: the video shows this text animating in progressively (letters/word appear to build up over a few frames — "WRO" → "WRONG PA" → "WRONG PASSCOD" → "WRONG PASSCODE!") — build this as a **typewriter/letter-by-letter reveal animation**, not a static instant-appear text.
- Below the mascot: a pill-shaped red **"TRY AGAIN"** button with a thin white dashed/stitched border detail (giving it a sticker-like cutout look), white bold uppercase label text.
- Tapping "TRY AGAIN" clears the 4 input boxes and returns the user to the Step 2 passcode screen, ready for a fresh attempt, with the digit boxes reset to empty.
- Do not lock the user out after repeated wrong attempts (no lockout/cooldown was shown) — keep retries unlimited unless you have a specific reason to change that.

✅ Checkpoint — Step 3

- ☐ Wrong-code entry reliably triggers this scene (test multiple wrong codes).
 - ☐ Background swaps to sparkle-textured pastel background distinct from the passcode screen.
 - ☐ Mascot displays a distinct "surprised/oops" pose different from any other scene's mascot pose.
 - ☐ "WRONG PASSCODE!" headline animates in progressively (letter-by-letter or word-by-word build-up), not instantly.
 - ☐ "TRY AGAIN" button is styled as a red pill/sticker button with legible white text.
 - ☐ Tapping "TRY AGAIN" clears passcode input and returns to Step 2 screen with all 4 boxes empty.
 - ☐ Retry flow can be repeated indefinitely without errors or memory leaks (test 5+ consecutive wrong attempts).
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STEP 4 — Build Scene 1c: Correct Passcode → Unlock Transition

Build Instructions

- When the correct 4-digit code is entered, the last box fills, and a brief **"UNLOCK"** confirmation state appears — the video shows a small pill button reading "UNL..." (truncated as "UNLOCK") appearing near the bottom-right of the passcode panel, suggesting a short-lived success button/label flashes before transitioning away. (**Estimated Implementation** for exact wording/duration — treat as a ~0.5-1s success confirmation state before auto-advancing.)
- After this brief confirmation, transition (crossfade or wipe) directly into the **"Surprise Awaiting <3"** scene (Step 5). Do not require an extra tap to proceed — the unlock should auto-advance.
- This is a critical trust moment in the experience — the transition should feel rewarding: consider a soft scale/glow pulse on the input boxes and a gentle full-screen crossfade rather than a hard cut.

✓ Checkpoint — Step 4

- ☐ Entering the correct 4-digit code (defined by the site owner/gift-giver, must be configurable, not hardcoded in a way that can't be changed per recipient) triggers the unlock path, distinctly different from the wrong-code path.
 - ☐ A brief success/"unlock" confirmation state is visible before the scene changes.
 - ☐ Transition to the next scene is automatic (no additional user tap required) and uses a smooth crossfade, not an abrupt cut.
 - ☐ Passcode value is configurable/editable by whoever is building the gift (i.e., this is treated as a CMS/config value, not hardcoded once and unchangeable).
 - ☐ Re-testing: reload the page, re-enter the correct code, confirm the unlock path works consistently every time (no flaky state).
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STEP 5 — Build Scene 2: "Surprise Awaiting <3" Teaser Screen

Build Instructions

- Full-bleed pastel background (light pink/lavender, same soft sparkle-particle texture family as the wrong-passcode scene, but this is a **positive** moment, not an error — keep tone celebratory, not alarming).
- Center-stage mascot chick in a shy/blushing bounce pose (slightly different pose than Wrong Passcode scene — eyes closed happily, cheeks blushing).
- Curved headline text above the mascot, same letter-by-letter animated reveal technique as Step 3: "**SURPRISE**" appears first (shorter/simpler state), then extends to "**SURPRISE AWAITING<3**" — confirms the site reuses the same animated-headline component across scenes with different copy, so build this headline reveal as a **reusable component**, not a one-off.
- Below the mascot: a pill-shaped button matching the sticker/stitched-border style from Step 3, this time in a softer pink tone, labeled "**SURPRISE**".
- Tapping the button (or after an auto-delay — **Estimated Implementation**, video suggests a tap-through) advances to Step 6 (first "Click on items to open" scene).

✓ Checkpoint — Step 5

- ☐ Reused animated-headline component correctly displays new copy ("SURPRISE" → "SURPRISE AWAITING<3") confirming component is reusable, not hardcoded per-scene.
 - ☐ Mascot pose is distinct from the Wrong Passcode mascot pose (visually confirm side-by-side).
 - ☐ Sparkle background texture is consistent in density/style with Step 3's background (shared background component).
 - ☐ "SURPRISE" pill button is tappable and reliably transitions to the next scene.
 - ☐ No dead-end: user cannot get stuck on this screen without a way forward.
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STEP 6 — Build Scene 3: "Click on Items to Open" — Interactive Gift Hub (First Occurrence)

This is a **hub/menu scene** that appears at least 3 times across the experience (confirmed in the video at three separate points), each time leading into a different sub-scene. Build it once as a reusable component that accepts a different "next destination" per item.

Build Instructions

- **Background:** full-bleed pastel mint/sage gingham-check pattern, decorated with scattered pastel butterflies (top-left corner) and stars.
- **Headline:** "click on items to open" in the deep red/maroon script font, arched slightly, positioned upper-center/right.
- **Bottom-left decorative element:** a hand-drawn wooden signpost illustration with a hanging sign that reads "CUTE" with a small heart — pure decoration, non-interactive.
- **Main interactive elements — two large tappable objects side-by-side, left-of-center:**
 1. **Large pink heart-shaped gift box** with a ribbon and bow across it (left position). This is a big single hotspot.
 2. **A second heart shape acting as a "shadow box" or scrapbook collage**, containing 4-5 small nested doodle icon stickers arranged inside it: a cassette tape, a small red heart/rosette badge, a bouquet/flower icon, and a camera icon. Each small icon **appears to be independently tappable** (they are visually separated stickers within the larger heart outline), not just one big hotspot — build each icon as its own hotspot leading to a different content scene.
- **Faint cameo illustration bottom-right corner:** a small illustrated couple (in the reference video this closely resembles a well-known movie couple's illustration style — **do not use copyrighted character art**; commission an original generic couple illustration in a similar warm, sketchy style instead).
- **Interaction/motion:** icons should have a subtle idle "breathing" animation (gentle scale pulse or sway) to visually invite tapping, plus a tap/press-down micro-animation (scale down slightly on touch, spring back).
- **Navigation dots:** a small horizontal dot/pagination indicator near the bottom edge of the screen is visible in later scenes (see Step 9 onward) — track scene position with a persistent bottom dot-indicator component starting from this scene forward, and a left/right chevron arrow appears at the edges of some scenes to allow manual back/forward paging in addition to tapping items directly. Build both the tap-driven navigation (tap an item → jump to its content) and the arrow-driven linear navigation (chevrons step forward/back through the scene sequence) since the video shows both patterns being used at different points.

✓ Checkpoint — Step 6

- ☐ Gingham background, butterflies, stars, and "CUTE" signpost all render correctly and match Step 1's asset style.
 - ☐ "click on items to open" headline is present, correctly styled and positioned.
 - ☐ Heart gift box is a single large tappable hotspot with visible affordance (cursor pointer / hover or touch feedback).
 - ☐ The second heart collage has **multiple independent hotspots** (cassette, rosette, bouquet, camera) each individually tappable, verified by clicking each icon separately and confirming each leads to different content.
 - ☐ Idle micro-animation (breathing/pulse) is present on interactive icons.
 - ☐ Tap/press feedback animation works on both mouse click and touch tap.
 - ☐ Bottom dot-pagination indicator is present and accurately reflects current scene position.
 - ☐ Left/right chevron navigation arrows are present and functional where applicable.
 - ☐ This entire scene is built as one reusable component so it can be reused for Steps 9 and 12 with different destination mappings, confirmed by checking the component is not duplicated/copy-pasted in the codebase.
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STEP 7 — Build Scene 4: Love Letter Reveal

Triggered by tapping the large heart gift box (or one of its icons) in Step 6.

Build Instructions

- **Background:** soft cream/blush background with faint decorative florals (roses) and a red ribbon/heart watermark motif behind the text, kept low-opacity so it doesn't compete with the letter text.
- **Headline (repeated):** "click on items to open" persists at the top in the same styling as Step 6 — confirming this scene is a **sub-panel/overlay layered on top of the hub scene**, not a fully separate page. Build it as an overlay/modal-style panel that slides or fades in over the hub background rather than a full scene replacement, matching this behavior.
- **Main content:** a multi-line **handwritten-style personal letter**, left-aligned, in the handwriting font, dark reddish-brown ink color. Content should be a warm, personal message (the reference shows a message about missing being physically present for a special day like Valentine's/an anniversary and sending love long-distance — **Estimated Implementation** for exact final copy; this is meant to be user-editable per recipient, so the real deliverable is the *editable text block*, not fixed wording).
- **Right side, next to the letter:** an illustrated bouquet of tulips, plus a small photo/illustration cameo of a couple in the bottom-right corner (again, use original artwork, not copyrighted characters).
- **Bottom-left:** the "CUTE" signpost decoration reappears, reinforcing it as a recurring background decorative element across this family of scenes.

- **Navigation:** a right-pointing chevron arrow (bottom-right) allows the user to move forward/back linearly; the item can also be dismissed to return to the Step 6 hub (**Estimated Implementation** for exact dismiss method — implement a clear back affordance regardless, such as tapping outside the panel or a back chevron).
- This letter content **must be a CMS/config-editable field**, since the whole product is a personalized-gift template — treat all name/message content across the entire site (letter text, recipient name, reasons list, photos, playlist, final award message) as data-driven from a single config source, not hardcoded per install.

✓ Checkpoint — Step 7

- ☐ Letter scene opens as an overlay on top of / replacing content within the Step 6 hub, with the hub's headline and background still visible/consistent behind it.
- ☐ Handwriting-style font renders the letter body legibly at all target screen sizes (test for line-length overflow on mobile).
- ☐ Floral/ribbon watermark graphics are low-opacity and do not reduce text legibility (run a contrast check).
- ☐ Bouquet illustration and couple cameo render correctly, using only original/non-copyrighted artwork.
- ☐ Forward/back chevron navigation works and returns user correctly to the Step 6 hub without breaking state.
- ☐ Letter text is pulled from an editable config/data field, verified by changing the text in config and confirming it updates on screen without touching layout code.

STEP 8 — Build Scene 5: "Everything I Love About You" — Heart Jar / Reasons List

Triggered by a different item on the Step 6 hub (in the video this content appears after the letter, likely from the rosette or bouquet icon).

Build Instructions

- **Background:** soft blush/pink with faint tulip/floral illustrations along the bottom edge of the screen.
- **Left side:** an illustrated **glass jar with a tied bow/ribbon lid**, filled with small **heart-shaped tags/stickers**, each heart containing a short handwritten label (examples visible: "eyes," "your gestures," "how you care for me," "your voice," "your smile," "how you listen to me," "your hugs"). Build this as a **repeatable list component**: a jar container that dynamically lays out N heart-shaped "reason" chips inside it, each with short editable text, so the gift-giver can add/remove reasons via config.
- **Right side:** large script headline reading **"Everything I Love About You"**, with a small counter/index label near it (video shows what looks like a small "MY 1" style tag — **Estimated Implementation**: likely a numbered index like "reason #1" or a page counter tied to the pagination system; implement as a small counter badge next to the headline).

- **Bottom edge:** decorative row of small illustrated tulip flowers spanning the width of the screen.
- **Navigation:** right-pointing chevron arrow at the right edge (bottom-right) to continue forward through the sequence.

✅ Checkpoint — Step 8

- ☐ Jar illustration renders with heart-shaped reason chips correctly nested inside/around it, not overflowing the jar artwork.
 - ☐ Reason chips are populated from a data list (add a test 8th reason via config and confirm it renders without layout breaking).
 - ☐ Script headline "Everything I Love About You" renders correctly with appropriate letter-spacing/kerning for a script font at this size.
 - ☐ Small counter/index badge is present and increments correctly if this scene is part of a multi-page reasons sequence.
 - ☐ Bottom tulip decorative row renders full-width without tiling artifacts.
 - ☐ Forward chevron correctly advances to the next scene in sequence.
 - ☐ Fully responsive: jar + heart chips remain legible and non-overlapping down to smallest supported mobile width (test 360px width explicitly).
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STEP 9 — Reuse Hub Component for Scene 6: "Click on Items to Open" (Second Occurrence)

Build Instructions

- Reuse the exact hub component built in Step 6 (same gingham background, headline, gift box, heart-collage icons, "CUTE" signpost, couple cameo). Only the **destination mapping** of each hotspot changes at this point in the flow — this time, tapping items leads toward the music/media content instead of the letter/jar content.
- Confirm the dot-pagination indicator now reflects a later position in the overall sequence (it should visibly differ from the Step 6 occurrence to show progress, not reset to the start).

✅ Checkpoint — Step 9

- ☐ Confirmed via code inspection that this scene instance re-uses the Step 6 component (not a duplicated copy with drifted styling).
 - ☐ Hotspot destinations correctly point to the music scene (Step 10) rather than the letter/jar scenes.
 - ☐ Pagination dot indicator shows correct/advanced position relative to Step 6's instance.
 - ☐ Visual regression check: this instance is pixel-consistent with Step 6's instance except for interactive destinations (background, type, icon styling identical).
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STEP 10 — Build Scene 7: Embedded Song / Music Video Card

Build Instructions

- **Background:** white/cream card floating on the same soft heart/star pale background used in Steps 3 and 5.
- **Main content:** a large embedded video-style thumbnail card, styled to resemble a YouTube video embed:
 - Small circular channel-avatar icon top-left with video title text next to it: "**Until I Found You - Stephen Sanchez ft. Em Beihold (Lyric Video)**" and a channel handle beneath it.
 - Large centered stylized text overlay reading "**Until I Found You**" in a bold handwritten/script treatment, with a small red circular play button icon positioned mid-word.
 - Smaller sub-text below: "**Stephen Sanchez ft. Em Beihold**".
 - Bottom-left corner: a small loop/repeat icon.
 - Bottom-right corner: a small "@handle" watermark and a YouTube logo/badge, plus a video scrubber bar with elapsed/total time readout ("0:00 / 0:00") and a small red progress dot at the start of the bar.
- **Below the embed card:** a persistent **mini audio-player control bar**, present in this and subsequent scenes:
 - Song title label: "UNTIL I FOUND YOU<3"
 - A horizontal progress/scrub slider with a round draggable handle.
 - Playback controls row: heart/favorite icon (left), previous-track icon, large central play/pause button, next-track icon, and a small options/menu icon (right).
- **Behavior:** Tapping the big play button on the embed transitions the card into an actively "playing" state — the embed area changes to show the real lyric-video content (see Step 11), while the mini control bar below reflects active playback (scrubber begins moving, play icon becomes pause icon).
- Build this as a genuine embedded player (e.g., a video/audio embed you control) rather than a static image, since the user is meant to actually hear/see the song play.
- Autoplay-with-sound must not fire without a user gesture (respect browser autoplay policy) — audio should only start after this explicit tap-to-play interaction, which conveniently matches what's shown in the video (user taps to start it).

✅ Checkpoint — Step 10

- ☐ Embed card renders with all labeled sub-elements (avatar, title, channel handle, play button, scrubber, loop icon, watermark).
- ☐ Mini persistent control bar renders below the embed with all 5 icons (favorite, previous, play/pause, next, menu) and functions correctly.
- ☐ Tapping play actually starts audio/video playback — verified with sound on.

- ☐ Playback does not autostart on scene load (must require explicit tap, matching browser autoplay policy and the observed video behavior).
 - ☐ Scrubber bar accurately reflects real playback position, not a static/fake animation.
 - ☐ Play/pause icon correctly toggles state based on actual playback status.
 - ☐ Loop icon is functional (toggles repeat) or clearly marked as decorative if not implemented — do not leave a broken-looking interactive element.
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STEP 11 — Build Scene 7b: Lyric Video Playback State

Build Instructions

- Once playing, the embed area displays the actual lyric-video content: a warm, sepia-toned vintage-style image/video of two people holding bouquets of wildflowers, with animated lyric text overlaid in white, centered: e.g. "**Georgia, wrap me up in all your, I want you in my arms**" timed to the song.
- A small watermark/handle ("@sydhslm" or similar creator credit) appears bottom-center of the video content — if using a real licensed lyric video asset, retain proper attribution; if building an original version, replace with your own subtle credit or omit.
- Two small circular icons appear bottom-right of the video frame during playback (in the reference these look like a checkmark/approve icon and a bookmark/save icon) — **Estimated Implementation:** implement as "mark as favorite song" and "save/bookmark" affordances consistent with the rest of the mini-player's iconography.
- Mini control bar beneath continues to reflect live playback position throughout.
- The right-edge chevron remains available to skip forward to the next scene even mid-playback — verify audio either continues in the background, fades out gracefully, or pauses cleanly (choose one deliberate behavior; do not let it error out or overlap incorrectly with the next scene, especially if the next scene also has ambient audio elements).

✅ Checkpoint — Step 11

- ☐ Lyric text overlays appear synced (even approximately) with the audio, not randomly timed.
 - ☐ Video/image content is warm-toned and thematically consistent with the rest of the site's romantic aesthetic.
 - ☐ Attribution/watermark is present and correctly licensed or replaced with original content — legal check completed.
 - ☐ The two small bottom-right icons are functional or intentionally decorative (documented which).
 - ☐ Navigating away mid-song produces a clean, tested audio behavior (defined explicitly: pause / fade-out / continue) — not silent failure or audio overlap bugs.
 - ☐ Confirmed working on both desktop (mouse) and mobile (touch) input for all playback controls.
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STEP 12 — Build Scene 8: Photo Memory Grid — "Here's a Little Reminder of How Pretty You Are"

Build Instructions

- **Background:** clean white/cream background, minimal decoration — small pixel-art-style heart icons (two, outlined in dotted/pixel style) centered at the top as a header flourish.
- **Main content:** a **horizontal row of 4 photo frames**, edge-to-edge, each showing a different personal photo of the recipient. Photos should have consistent aspect ratio/cropping (portrait-oriented, equal width columns) so the row reads as one clean strip, not misaligned thumbnails.
- **Caption below the photo row:** center-aligned two-line text in the pink/rose accent color and script-adjacent rounded font: "**Here's a little reminder of how pretty you are <3**" — this text is shown building in progressively (confirmed by seeing "Here's a littl" mid-animation before completing) — reuse the same letter/word-by-word text reveal animation technique established in Steps 3 and 5, applied here to body copy instead of a big headline (so make the reveal component flexible enough to handle both headline-scale and caption-scale text).
- **Top-right corner:** a small pill-shaped "Back" button, muted/outlined style (lower visual weight than the primary CTA buttons elsewhere) allowing the user to return to the previous scene without going through the full forward sequence.
- Photos must be user-uploadable/config-driven (this is a template product — the 4 images need to be swappable per recipient without a code change).

✅ Checkpoint — Step 12

- ☐ 4-photo row renders with consistent sizing/cropping regardless of the uploaded source image's original aspect ratio (verify with a portrait, landscape, and square test image).
 - ☐ Pixel-heart header icons render correctly and are decorative-only (confirm they're not mistakenly tappable/leading nowhere).
 - ☐ Caption text uses the shared progressive-reveal component (confirmed via code reuse, not a re-implementation).
 - ☐ "Back" button is present, correctly de-emphasized in styling relative to primary buttons, and functionally returns to the correct prior scene.
 - ☐ Photos are loaded from swappable config/data source, not hardcoded file references — verified by swapping in 4 placeholder test images via config only.
 - ☐ Layout holds on mobile widths without photos becoming so narrow they're illegible (define a minimum photo width and either scroll or stack below that threshold — see Step 17).
-

STEP 13 — Reuse Hub Component for Scene 9: "Click on Items to Open" (Third/Final Occurrence)

Build Instructions

- Reuse the Step 6 hub component once more. This final pass routes the user toward the closing "award" scene (Step 14) — meaning by this point every item on the hub across its 3 appearances should collectively have led the user through: love letter → reasons jar → song/music → photo grid → final award, confirming the hub is really acting as a **recurring navigation checkpoint** the user passes through 3 times on the way through the full story, not 3 unrelated screens that happen to look similar.
- Map out the full hotspot → destination matrix explicitly during development (a simple table of "hub occurrence #" × "icon" × "destination scene") so QA can verify every path is reachable and nothing dead-ends or double-routes by accident.

✅ Checkpoint — Step 13

- ☐ Full hotspot-to-destination matrix is documented (all 3 hub occurrences × all icons on each).
 - ☐ QA has manually tapped every single hotspot across all 3 hub occurrences and confirmed each leads to the correct unique destination.
 - ☐ No dead-end hotspots exist (every tappable icon goes somewhere).
 - ☐ No duplicate/orphaned content exists that no hotspot links to (every scene built in Steps 7, 8, 10-12 is reachable from at least one hub occurrence).
 - ☐ Dot-pagination indicator correctly shows this as the final/latest hub occurrence in sequence.
-

STEP 14 — Build Scene 10: Final Reveal — "BEST GIRLFRIEND AWARD" Certificate

This is the emotional climax / final card of the experience.

Build Instructions

- **Background:** clean white/cream background with a soft, low-opacity blush heart-shaped glow/watermark centered behind the content (a large soft-focus pink heart shape sitting behind the text, giving a warm glow rather than a hard graphic).
- **Content, top to bottom, centered, serif/formal-elegant type treatment (this scene should read more "certificate/award" formal than the scrapbook-cute styling used elsewhere — a deliberate tonal shift for the closing emotional beat):**
 1. Large serif headline: "BEST GIRLFRIEND AWARD"
 2. Small subtext: "this award is presented to:"
 3. Large elegant script name field: **recipient's name** (shown as "Lara Jean" in the reference — this MUST be a config/data-driven field, the single most important personalization point in the entire template).
 4. A thin horizontal divider rule.

5. A short personal closing message in a smaller serif font (2-3 sentences, warm and sincere in tone — again, this is a config-editable field, not fixed copy).
 6. A small illustrated ribbon/rosette award badge icon (gold star on a pink ribbon medallion) centered at the very bottom, as a decorative "seal."
- **Navigation:** a right-pointing chevron at the right edge suggests there may be additional content after this card (**Estimated Implementation** — the reference video cuts off shortly after reaching this scene; if you have no further content planned, either remove the forward chevron here or loop it back to a graceful closing/replay state per Step 15).
 - This card is the natural "screenshot moment" of the whole experience — treat it as needing to look flawless when captured as a static image (many recipients will screenshot this card specifically), so pay extra attention to font kerning, contrast, and centering here relative to other scenes.

✓ Checkpoint — Step 14

- ☐ Certificate-style formal serif type is visually distinct from the cute/scrapbook type used in earlier scenes — confirm this tonal shift reads intentionally, not like an inconsistent bug.
 - ☐ Recipient name field pulls from config/data, tested by swapping in 3 different sample names and confirming layout doesn't break with a very short name or a long double name.
 - ☐ Closing message field is config-editable, tested with a placeholder long-form message to confirm text wrapping holds up.
 - ☐ Ribbon/badge icon renders crisp and centered at all tested breakpoints.
 - ☐ Soft heart glow watermark is subtle enough not to reduce text contrast/legibility (contrast-check against WCAG AA for the body text at minimum).
 - ☐ Forward chevron either leads somewhere intentional or is removed/replaced per the decision made above — no dangling non-functional arrow.
 - ☐ Manually screenshot this scene at both desktop and mobile size and visually confirm it looks "share-ready" with no clipped text or misaligned elements.
-

STEP 15 — Build the Closing State (End of Experience)

The reference video ends shortly after the award card, so this step is largely **Estimated Implementation** — but every real product needs a defined ending, so build one deliberately rather than leaving a dead-end.

Build Instructions

- Recommended pattern: after the award card, provide a simple, low-key closing affordance — e.g., a small "Replay" or "Back to the beginning" pill button, OR simply let the award card be the natural resting end-state with no further forced navigation (many recipients will just sit on this screen).
- Do not auto-redirect the user away from the award card — let them linger on it as long as they want.

- If you want a "credits" style close (matching the observed on-video social handle callout "Contact me for more details — template_diaryy — Template Diary | Digital templates"), that appears to be an artifact of the **template seller's own promotional video overlay**, not part of the actual website itself — do **not** build that promotional watermark into the site; it belongs to the marketing video, not the product.

✅ Checkpoint — Step 15

- ☐ The experience has a clear, intentional resting end-state (confirmed: user is never stuck mid-transition or facing a broken/blank screen).
 - ☐ No promotional/seller watermark content from the reference marketing video has been mistakenly built into the actual site.
 - ☐ If a Replay function is implemented, confirm it correctly resets all state (passcode boxes, playback position, hub pagination) back to the true beginning with no leftover state bugs.
 - ☐ Full end-to-end manual walkthrough completed once: passcode → wrong attempt → correct unlock → surprise teaser → all 3 hub passes and all sub-scenes → final award card → close/replay, with zero errors along the way.
-

STEP 16 — Make Every Scene Responsive

Do this as its own dedicated pass after all scenes exist in Step 0-15, rather than trying to perfect responsiveness scene-by-scene (avoids rework when shared components change).

Build Instructions

- The reference was captured on a phone (portrait, 720×1280) — treat **mobile as the primary target**, then scale up gracefully to tablet/desktop, rather than the reverse.
- **Passcode screen (Step 2):** on narrow mobile, keep the left/right split if width allows down to ~480px; below that, consider stacking the mascot illustration above the keypad instead of side-by-side, or shrinking the illustration panel to a smaller top banner so the keypad remains full-size and easily tappable (keypad buttons must stay large enough for comfortable thumb tapping — minimum ~44×44px touch target).
- **Hub scenes (Step 6/9/13):** icons must remain individually tappable at small sizes — do not let the heart-collage icons shrink below a comfortable tap target; if needed, increase spacing/tap-padding around small icons rather than shrinking the visual icon itself.
- **Photo grid (Step 12):** 4-across on desktop/tablet; on narrow mobile, either keep 4-across at reduced size (if photos remain recognizable) or allow horizontal scroll/swipe for the photo strip rather than wrapping to a broken grid.
- **Letter/jar/award scenes:** ensure text reflows naturally and font sizes scale with a responsive type scale (not fixed pixel sizes) so long letter text doesn't overflow its container on small screens.
- **Music embed (Step 10/11):** maintain aspect ratio on resize; controls must remain reachable/tappable on mobile without being obscured by on-screen keyboard or browser chrome.

- Test both portrait and landscape mobile orientation explicitly — the source material is portrait, but users will rotate devices.

✅ Checkpoint — Step 16

- ☐ Every one of the 10 scenes built in Steps 2-14 has been manually tested at: 1440px desktop, 1024px tablet, 768px small tablet, 428px large mobile, 360px small mobile.
 - ☐ Every interactive element (keypad keys, hub icons, buttons, chevrons, player controls) meets a minimum 44×44px touch target at the smallest tested width.
 - ☐ No horizontal overflow/scrollbar appears unintentionally at any tested width (except where horizontal photo scroll is a deliberate design choice).
 - ☐ Text never overflows its container or gets clipped at any tested width.
 - ☐ Landscape mobile orientation tested and does not break layout.
-

STEP 17 — Motion & Micro-Interaction Polish Pass

Build Instructions

- Standardize animation timing across the whole site so it feels like one cohesive product rather than mismatched scenes:
 - Scene transitions (crossfade between scenes): ~400-600ms, ease-in-out. (Estimated Implementation)
 - Letter-by-letter headline reveal (Steps 3, 5, 12): ~40-80ms per character/word chunk. (Estimated Implementation)
 - Button press feedback: ~100-150ms scale-down/spring-back.
 - Idle "breathing" icon pulse (Step 6): slow, ~2-3s loop, subtle (scale 1.0 → 1.03), so it reads as inviting rather than distracting.
- Respect `prefers-reduced-motion`: provide a reduced-motion fallback where headline reveals appear instantly (or with a simple fade) and idle pulsing/breathing animations are disabled, for users with that OS/browser setting enabled.
- Keep motion consistent in *direction* — e.g., forward-navigation transitions should consistently slide/fade in from the same direction throughout, and backward-navigation should mirror it, so users build an intuitive spatial sense of "forward" vs "back."

✅ Checkpoint — Step 17

- ☐ A single shared animation-timing config/token set is used across all scenes (confirmed via code, not just "looks similar").
 - ☐ `prefers-reduced-motion` is detected and correctly disables/simplifies non-essential animations (test by enabling this OS setting and re-walking the whole flow).
 - ☐ Forward/backward transition direction is consistent throughout the entire experience.
 - ☐ No animation causes layout shift/jank (test with browser dev tools performance/rendering panel — no dropped frames on a mid-range mobile device profile).
-

STEP 18 — Accessibility & Performance Pass

Build Instructions

- **Accessibility:**
 - All interactive elements (keypad keys, hub icons, buttons, chevrons, player controls) must be reachable via keyboard (Tab/Enter/Space) in addition to mouse/touch, even though the reference experience is touch-first.
 - Add appropriate ARIA labels to icon-only buttons (e.g., the heart-collage icons, play/pause, favorite, chevrons) since they carry no visible text label.
 - Maintain sufficient color contrast for all body text against its background (many scenes use light pastel-on-pastel combinations — explicitly verify each text/background pairing).
 - Passcode input should be usable by screen reader users (announce box fill state, announce wrong/correct result).
- **Performance:**
 - Lazy-load below-the-fold/not-yet-visible scene assets (photos, video embed) rather than loading everything on first paint, since this is an image/illustration-heavy experience.
 - Compress all illustration/photo assets appropriately (serve responsive image sizes, modern formats like WebP/AVIF with fallback).
 - Preload only the fonts and assets needed for the first scene (passcode screen); defer the rest.
 - Audio/video (Step 10/11) should not preload fully until the user taps play.

✅ Checkpoint — Step 18

- ☐ Full keyboard-only walkthrough of the entire experience completed successfully (no mouse/touch used).
 - ☐ Screen reader spot-check completed on passcode entry and at least 2 other scenes.
 - ☐ Automated accessibility audit (e.g., axe or Lighthouse accessibility score) run on every scene; no critical/serious issues outstanding.
 - ☐ Lighthouse performance score checked on mobile throttled network profile; no render-blocking asset issues flagged for the first scene.
 - ☐ All images confirmed compressed/responsive (spot-check network tab for oversized image downloads).
 - ☐ Video/audio confirmed not preloading before user interaction (check network tab on scene load).
-

STEP 19 — Full QA Pass

Build Instructions

- Run a structured QA sweep across browsers and devices before calling this done. Use the matrix below as your test plan.

Test Area	Chrome	Safari	Firefox	Edge	iOS Safari (touch)	Android Chrome (touch)
Passcode entry + wrong/correct paths	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
All 3 hub occurrences + every hotspot	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Letter, jar, photo, award scenes render	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Audio/video playback + controls	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Animations/transitions smooth, no jank	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Responsive layout at all breakpoints	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Config-driven content swap (name/photos/letter)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Accessibility (keyboard + screen reader)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

✅ Checkpoint — Step 19

- ☐ Every cell in the matrix above is checked off with a passing result, or has a logged, triaged bug against it.
- ☐ All critical/blocking bugs from the sweep are fixed and re-tested.
- ☐ A second person (not the original builder) has independently walked through the full experience once, start to finish, and confirmed it matches the reference video's intended flow.

STEP 20 — Final Personalization Config & Deployment

Build Instructions

- Before shipping to an actual recipient, confirm every personalization data point is centralized in one config file/CMS entry, not scattered:
 - 4-digit passcode
 - Recipient name (award scene)
 - Letter body text
 - "Reasons I love you" list items (jar scene)

- 4 gallery photos
- Song choice (title/embed source)
- Closing award message
- Deploy to a stable, permanent hosting URL suitable for sharing as a gift link (confirm HTTPS, confirm the URL is short/shareable, confirm the site loads correctly on a cold cache from a fresh device/network to simulate the real recipient's first-open experience).
- Do a final "gift simulation" test: have someone unfamiliar with the build open the real shareable link cold, on their own phone, and complete the full flow start to finish without guidance, to catch any friction the builder is too familiar with the product to notice.

✓ Checkpoint — Step 20

- ☐ Single config source confirmed to control all 7 personalization data points listed above.
 - ☐ Site deployed to final HTTPS URL.
 - ☐ Cold-cache first load tested on a fresh device/network profile.
 - ☐ Independent "gift simulation" tester has completed the full flow unaided and confirmed it feels complete, emotionally coherent, and bug-free.
 - ☐ Sign-off: all 20 Steps above show fully checked checkpoints with zero unresolved items.
-

Appendix — Estimated Implementation Summary

The following items were not shown with full certainty in the reference video and were built using best-judgment estimates. Revisit these if you obtain higher-fidelity reference material:

- Exact hex color values (Step 1)
- Exact font families (Step 1)
- Whether a branded loading splash exists before the passcode screen (Step 2)
- Exact wording/duration of the "UNLOCK" success confirmation (Step 4)
- Exact dismiss/back interaction on the letter overlay (Step 7)
- Exact meaning of the "MY 1" counter badge on the reasons scene (Step 8)
- Function of the two small bottom-right icons during lyric video playback (Step 11)
- What (if anything) exists after the final award card (Step 14/15)
- All animation timing values (Step 17)